

FARMINGTON PUBLIC SCHOOLS · ACES AI CONFERENCE 2026

BUILDING AI CHAMPIONS

TJ Neville · Andy Marshall · with AI Champion Nicole Bastiaanse-Fritch

FRIDAY
SEPTEMBER 25, 2026

WHAT TO EXPECT

SESSION OVERVIEW

0:00 - 0:40 · forty minutes

DISTRICT SHOWCASE

How we designed and implemented the program, what we learned, and what changes next.

0:40 - 0:50

PARTICIPANT PERSPECTIVE

An AI Champion on the experience.

0:50 - 1:00

FACILITATED Q&A

A chance to ask an AI Champion your questions.

PARTICIPANTS WILL

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand how one district designed and implemented an AI Champions cohort to build teacher leadership, support responsible AI adoption, and connect district AI guidance to authentic classroom and professional practice
- ☐ Examine practical structures that supported implementation, including cohort selection, asynchronous professional development, coaching, artifact collection, reflection routines, cohort data collection and analysis, and end-of-year synthesis through AI Champions Wrapped
- ☐ Identify adaptable resources, implementation ideas, and design questions you can use to develop or refine an AI teacher-leadership model in your own school or district

HOW WE'LL SHARE IT

DESIGN DECISIONS, NOT A PRESCRIPTION



The aim isn't to hand you an exact model. It's to show what we built, why, and what we learned, so you can decide what fits your district.

The image features a collection of architectural blueprints spread across a wooden surface. The blueprints are dark blue with white grid lines and technical drawings, including floor plans, elevations, and circular details. A central, horizontal, cream-colored banner with a slightly distressed edge contains the text 'DISTRICT SHOWCASE' in a bold, black, hand-drawn font. A small, light-colored rectangular object, possibly a piece of tape or a small block, is visible near the top center. In the bottom right corner, a yellow pencil with a pink eraser and a sharpened lead tip lies on one of the blueprints.

DISTRICT SHOWCASE

WHY WE BUILT THE PROGRAM



The challenge we were trying to solve



Why one-time AI PD wasn't enough



Why a teacher-leadership model felt necessary

THE GOAL.

Build internal capacity for responsible, human-centered AI adoption.

IN FARMINGTON PUBLIC SCHOOLS

WHAT IS AN AI CHAMPION?



Explore and experiment

Try AI tools in low-stakes settings and build fluency through small, practical challenges.



Model responsible use

Show colleagues what thoughtful AI use looks like, including what not to do.



Lead and lift others

Share resources, run short sessions, and support colleagues.



In the toolkit: **Planning checklist**
PRE-LAUNCH AND DESIGN DRAWER

PARTICIPATION, EXPECTATIONS, AND SELECTION

WHAT WE ASKED OF CHAMPIONS

- 10 missions across 12 weeks
- Roughly one mission a week, with buffer weeks built in
- Coaching check-ins along the way
- Sharing what you build with colleagues



How Champions were nominated and selected

- A Google Form went to all staff, explaining what the program was about
- Staff could nominate themselves or a colleague
- A nomination showed interest. It wasn't a commitment
- Kickoff meetings at schools let nominees learn more and decide whether to continue



In the toolkit: **Nomination form**
PRE-LAUNCH AND DESIGN DRAWER

THE TECHNOLOGY INTEGRATION TEAM'S ROLE



DESIGNERS

We built the program: the missions, the mission site, and the structure Champions worked within.



COACHES

We supported every Champion one-to-one, checking in, troubleshooting, and helping them keep going.

WHY ASYNCHRONOUS PD PLUS COACHING



ASYNCHRONOUS PD

Self-paced missions that fit around a school schedule.



COACHING

Human support when Champions got stuck, and a push to keep going.



**MORE THAN AN
ASYNCHRONOUS
COURSE**

THE ASYNCHRONOUS LEARNING MODEL

10 missions

4. learning arcs



In the toolkit: **Mission website**
PROFESSIONAL LEARNING DRAWER

WHAT TRANSFERS

THE MISSIONS MATTER, BUT THE STRUCTURE MATTERS MORE

WHAT'S MORE TRANSFERABLE

Sustained learning

Small experiments

Reflection

Authentic professional use



In the toolkit: **Mission template**
PROFESSIONAL LEARNING DRAWER

COACHING AND ONGOING SUPPORT



The coaching approach



One-to-one coaching



How Champions could seek support



How coaching complemented the missions



In the toolkit: **Coaching guide**
COACHING AND SUPPORT DRAWER

WHAT WE LEARNED

WHAT COACHING TAUGHT US



What we tracked through
the coaching log



When Champions needed
help



In the toolkit: **Coaching log**

COACHING AND SUPPORT DRAWER

COLLECTING EVIDENCE



Artifacts produced through the missions

Captured on the mission tracker



Participant reflections

Captured on the mission tracker



Coaching interactions

Captured in our coaching logs



End-of-program survey

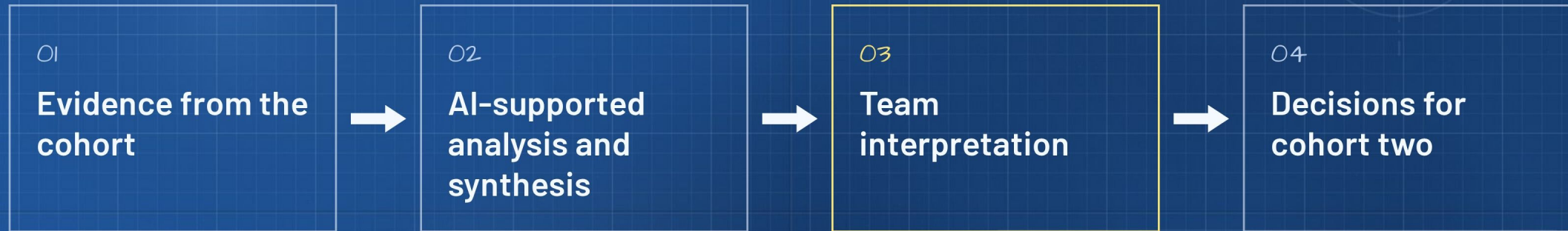
Completed at the end of the program



In the toolkit: **End-of-program survey**
EVIDENCE AND LEARNING DRAWER

HOW WE USED IT

A FEEDBACK LOOP AROUND THE INITIATIVE



AI HELPED WITH THE ANALYSIS AND SYNTHESIS.

Human judgment stayed at the center of interpretation and decisions about cohort two.



In the toolkit: **AI-assisted analysis prompts**
EVIDENCE AND LEARNING DRAWER

WHAT CHANGES FOR COHORT TWO

KEEP

What worked and should remain

CHANGE

What should be modified, based on cohort-one evidence

EXPLORE

What we still want to test or learn



In the toolkit: **Keep, Change, Explore**
SHOWCASE, REFLECT AND SCALE DRAWER

WHERE WE'RE LOOKING

AREAS ON THE DRAWING BOARD

INSIDE THE PROGRAM

Pacing

Mission design

Coaching frequency and structure

Updating missions as models and AI platforms evolve

ACROSS THE DISTRICT

Alignment with districtwide PD

Avoiding duplication with learning teachers already had

Champions supporting broader district implementation



In the toolkit: **Keep, Change, Explore**

SHOWCASE, REFLECT AND SCALE DRAWER

BEFORE THE Q&A

FIVE-MINUTE TOOLKIT EXPLORATION

- 1 Open the toolkit to the Pre-Launch and Design drawer
- 2 Spend a few minutes with the Planning Checklist
- 3 Write down one implementation question about how a program like this gets started or sustained

5:00

ONE RESOURCE.
ONE QUESTION.
HOLD IT FOR THE Q+A.



In the toolkit: **Planning checklist**
PRE-LAUNCH AND DESIGN DRAWER



AI CHAMPION WALKTHROUGH · SECTION 2

Building the K-4 Inclusive Art Pipeline Gem

From complex standards and accessibility needs to a personalized, editable slide deck starting point.

Nicole Bastiaanse-Fritch
Farmington District
Visual Art Educator

The Mission: Four Non-Negotiables

Programming a custom Gem to embed essential instructional constraints into every generated lesson.



Big 6 Art Ideas

Portrait, Still Life,
Landscape, Architecture,
3D Art, and Design
frameworks.



Farmington VGC

Empowered Learners,
Disciplined Thinkers, and
Collaborative Producers.



UDL & Universal Access

Tactile, auditory, and
mobility adaptations built
into every single step.



Safety & Ethics

Strict privacy guardrails:
zero generated images of
students with needs.

The Artifact

The Automated Slide-by-Slide Pipeline

From topic input to an immediately editable classroom presentation.



- 1. Input Prompt & Grade Level**
Enter topic, Big 6 category, and targeted student needs.
- 2. Gem Generates Full Structure**
Outputs 6-slide outline, artist resources, and accessibility matrix.
- 3. Teacher Personalization**
Use as starting point; refine slides and prep tactile tools.

From Blank Page to Creative Curator

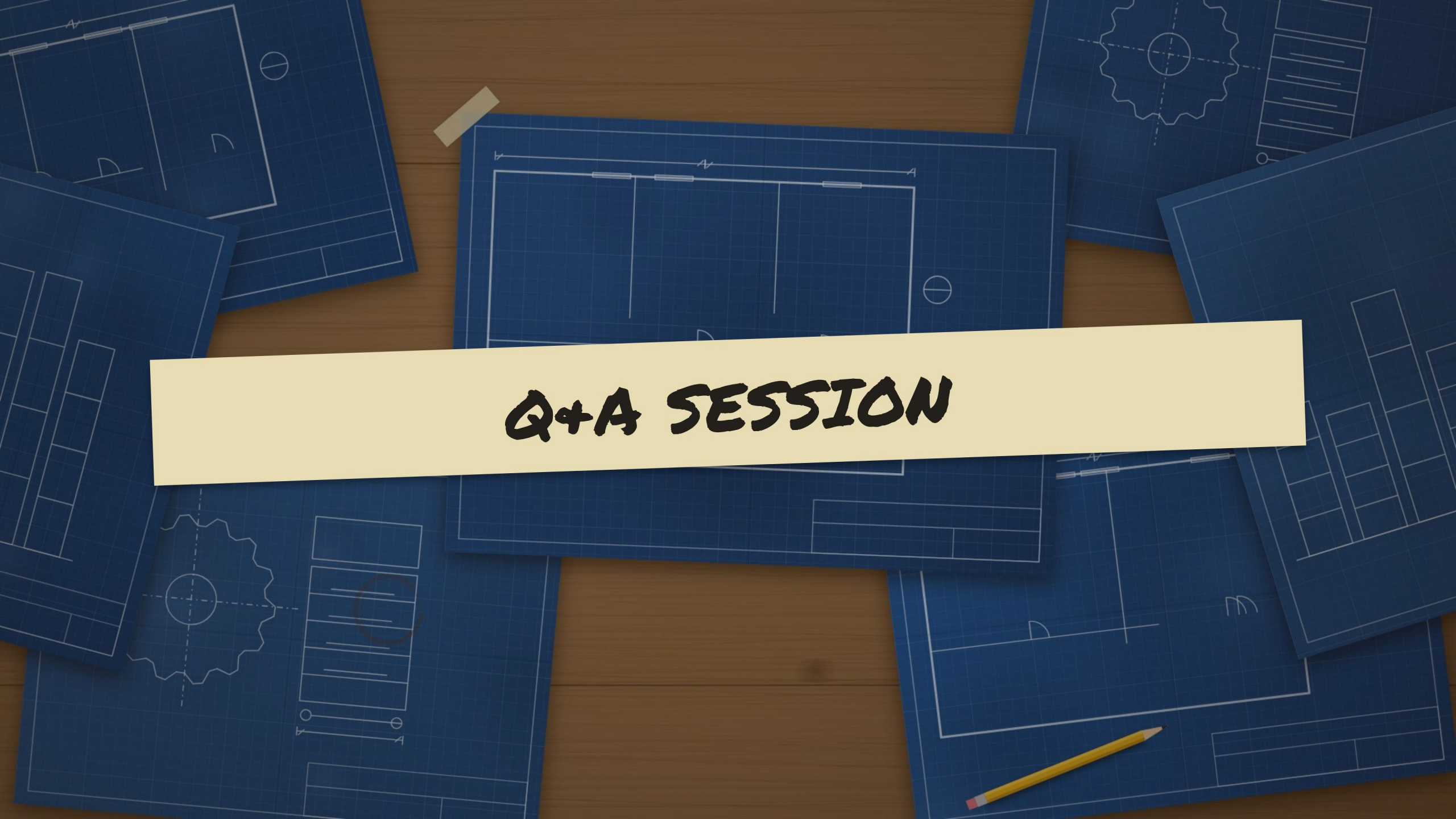


Blank Page Friction

AI handles back-end alignment and initial slide structure, freeing my energy for hands-on studio mentoring and personalizing tactile materials.

The background features several overlapping blueprints on a wooden surface. The blueprints contain various technical drawings, including floor plans, mechanical parts like gears, and structural elements. A small piece of yellow tape is visible on the top left. A yellow pencil lies on the bottom right blueprint. A yellow banner with the text 'AI CHAMPION SPOTLIGHT' is centered across the middle of the image.

AI CHAMPION SPOTLIGHT

The background features several overlapping blueprints on a wooden surface. The blueprints contain various technical drawings, including floor plans, mechanical parts like gears, and structural elements. A small piece of yellow tape is visible on the top left. A yellow pencil lies on the bottom right blueprint. A yellow sticky note is placed horizontally across the center of the image.

Q&A SESSION



THANK YOU

TJ Neville · Andy Marshall · Nicole Bastiaanse-Fritch

Farmington Public Schools · Technology Integration